

PINK QUILL

Tillandsia cyanea

Originally from the rain forests of Ecuador, this energetic, almost neon-colored plant brings a big wow to the home with its overlapping bright-pink bracts, which look like an old-fashioned quill and stay vibrant for months. Place it where you spend lots of time so you can enjoy it as much as possible.

“My neon bracts will electrify your room.”

Help me thrive



POSITION

Place in a warm room of 50–79°F (10–26°C), with bright, indirect light. Also likes good air circulation so a spot near a window will suit it.



POTTING

Repot to the next size up when roots grow through the bottom of the pot or circle inside it. Use a terrestrial bromeliad compost.



GROWTH RATE

Grows quickly for its size to a height of 1ft (30cm) and a width of 1½ft (40cm), taking around 3 years to reach its full flowering size.



CARE

From late spring to midfall, water when dry, giving a half-strength, low-nitrogen liquid feed monthly. Stop feeding in winter but keep watering.



I'll cheer you up

My bright pink quill is sure to grab your attention, with pink being a positive, exuberant, and cheering color. My flowers, meanwhile, are a vivid purple, and this bold combination can't help but lift your spirits.



Let's make babies

I am monocarpic, which means I die once I have flowered, but I can live on through the baby offsets that grow at my base. These “pups” can be separated from me and replanted in a fresh potting mix to grow on their own.